Baseline Calibration
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

3

TARGET

Flip the active Lab Rat to its other side. That side remains active until another effect flips it.

Every breakthrough begins by proving the researcher probably still works.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Fine Motor Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

3

TARGET

A Yellow die must be committed to this Experiment. If unable to do so, increase the Target by 1.

Tiny claws. Tiny screws. Absolutely no margin for error.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Structural Stress Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Reveal 1 additional Upgrade for this Experiment. Resolve the normal Upgrade choice using all revealed options.

Nobulous calls the third prototype a control. Nobody asks what it controls.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Contaminated Tissue
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Discard the revealed Upgrades and reveal 2 new Upgrades. These become the Upgrades for this Experiment.

The sample was sterile until Nobulous explained his definition of sterile.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Performance Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Discard the top 2 cards of the Experiment deck face down without resolving them.

The schedule has been accelerated by removing the parts involving caution.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Load-Bearing Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

A Purple die must be committed to this Experiment. If unable to do so, discard this Experiment and draw another one, replacing any revealed Upgrades.

Add weight until something fails. Preferably not the researcher.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Diagnostic Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

If you commit a Blue die to this Experiment, you may look at the next Experiment and return it to the top of the deck.

The instruments say everything is fine. The smoke has submitted a dissenting report.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Rapid Response Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

A Green die must be committed to this Experiment. If unable to do so, discard the stronger revealed Upgrade and continue the Experiment.

There is no time to do it right, only time to make it testable.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Full-Spectrum Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Committed dice must include 3 different colors.

Nobulous requested versatility. The equipment requested mercy.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

Workspace Efficiency Study
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

You may only commit two dice to this Experiment.

Four researchers. One bench. Zero lessons learned.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Restricted Materials Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Place the Red die on the active Rat. Red cannot be used for this Experiment.

The best reagent is unavailable for reasons marked administrative.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Independent Performance Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

You cannot borrow a die during this Experiment.

Collaboration introduces confounds. Nobulous has generously removed collaboration.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Resource Depletion Study
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

During your second Strategy phase, you may commit no additional dice.

There was a second prototype. Past tense.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Reliability Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Hits and Crits on Purple and Blue dice in the first Strategy phase must be rerolled.

It only fails when you need it, which is remarkably consistent.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Reagent Exclusion Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

4

TARGET

Randomly select one available die belonging to the active Rat. That die cannot be committed to this Experiment.

Science advances rapidly once you stop checking the labels.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Containment Failure
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

5

TARGET

You may choose to reduce the Target by 2. If you do, before committing, roll a Yellow die. On a hit or Crit, banish one available Blue die. Otherwise, banish that Yellow die.

The blast shield performed exactly as specified. The blast did not.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Endurance Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

5

TARGET

STR is 1 for this Experiment.

The experiment is repeatable. Unfortunately, so is the overtime.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Field Retrofit Trial
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

5

TARGET

If successful, you may swap one of the active Rat's Upgrades with one of the revealed Upgrades. Specimens cannot be swapped.

The replacement fits perfectly once you stop asking what it replaced.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

BAT
EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT
EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT
EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

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EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT
EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT
EXPERIMENT
THE NOBULOUS SET

Methodological Optimization
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

5

TARGET

You may reduce the Target to 0. If you do, take the weaker revealed Upgrade and Splice the stronger revealed Upgrade into the Prototyrant. If tied, choose which to take.

Why test both prototypes when the Prototyrant can test the better one?

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Degraded Tissue Study
BUILD-A-TYRANT EXPERIMENT

5

TARGET

If successful, reduce the Prototyrant's Health dial by 2.

The tissue is weaker than projected. Nobulous has classified this as progress.

If at least one revealed Upgrade is a Specimen, +1 Target total.

Serrated Claws
P1 - POWER

2

VALUE

+1 damage from each Blue or Green basic hit you apply during this attack.

Fine motor control was sacrificed for a more persuasive handshake.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Reinforced Jaw
P2 - POWER

3

VALUE

Add +2 damage to this attack if at least one Purple hit is applied.

The bite test ended when the test fixture stopped existing.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Capacitor Muscles
P3 - POWER

3

VALUE

Commit one exhausted Purple or Blue die to the current attack. It remains exhausted afterward.

Why rest a muscle when you can overvolt it?

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Piercing Horn
P4 - POWER

4

VALUE

Add +2 damage. If you roll a Yellow hit or Crit, bypass one Defense Upgrade when assigning this attack.

Evolution took millennia. Nobulous used a drill press.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Spring-Loaded Legs
M1 - MOBILITY

2

VALUE

Roll 1 exhausted Green die. It must match a color already committed to the attack; exhaust it afterward.

The landing remains an unsolved engineering problem.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Prehensile Tail
M2 - MOBILITY

2

VALUE

Roll 1 exhausted Yellow die. It must match a color already committed to the attack; exhaust it afterward.

Another limb means another place to hold something dangerous.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Tripwire Tendons
M3 - MOBILITY

3

VALUE

Opponent exhausts one Green die; if unable, one Yellow die, if able.

Anatomically questionable. Tactically hilarious.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

EXPERIMENT

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

Evasive Reflexes
M4 - MOBILITY

3

VALUE

Remove 1 success from the opponent's next attack.

The nervous system now reacts several moments before good judgment.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Thickened Hide
D1 - DEFENSE

2

VALUE

Reduce incoming damage by 1.

Subtle? No. Puncture-resistant? Increasingly.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Layered Carapace
D2 - DEFENSE

3

VALUE

Reduce incoming damage by 2.

Nobulous discovered the elegant principle of adding more shell.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Chromatic Plating
D3 - DEFENSE

3

VALUE

Reduce damage dealt by Blue and Green dice by 1 each. Yellow dice are unaffected.

The coating blocks two wavelengths and several reasonable questions.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Reactive Shell
D4 - DEFENSE

4

VALUE

Reduce damage dealt by Purple and Yellow dice by 1 each.

It hardens on impact. It also hardens when startled.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Acute Hearing
S1 - SENSES

2

VALUE

+1 STR during your next turn.

You can hear the Tyrant coming. You can also hear Nobulous chewing.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Predatory Focus
S2 - SENSES

3

VALUE

+1 STR for the current attack.

Everything unnecessary disappears, including most ethical concerns.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Rapid Metabolism
S3 - SENSES

2

VALUE

Recover 1 additional die this turn.

Calories in. Violence out. The lab has charts.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

Neural Overclock
S4 - SENSES

4

VALUE

Recover 2 additional dice this turn.

The brain is operating beyond specification. So is the smoke.

Tap to use. A tapped Upgrade cannot absorb damage.

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

Titanium-Toothed Mole
POWER SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Add +3 damage to the current attack.

It tunneled through the enclosure, the wall, and part of Accounting.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Voltaic Mantis
POWER SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Add +2 damage; one applied Crit deals +2 additional damage.

Do not ground the specimen. Do not touch the specimen. Too late.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Blink Hare
MOBILITY SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Roll up to 2 exhausted dice matching colors already committed to this attack.

It does not teleport. Nobulous is almost certain.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Ghost Gecko
MOBILITY SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Remove 2 successes from the opponent's next attack.

The camera sees it. The eye does not. The paperwork sees neither.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Ironback Beetle
DEFENSE SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Reduce incoming damage by 3.

The shell survived the press. The press has been replaced.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Prismatic Tortoise
DEFENSE SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Reduce damage from two colors of your choice by 1 per die for this attack.

Its shell refracts light, force, and straightforward explanations.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Echo Bat
SENSES SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

+1 STR for this turn and recover 1 additional die afterward.

One squeak maps the room. Two squeaks map your fillings.

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Regenerator Newt
SENSES SPECIMEN

SPECIMEN

5

VALUE

Recover 3 additional dice this turn.

Nobulous stopped asking what grows back. The answer was "yes."

Specimen. At most 1 may be retained for the Imposter Research Pool.

Overwhelming Mass
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

This attack deals +3 damage.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

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UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

UPGRADE · SPECIMEN

THE NOBULOUS SET

Adaptive Strike
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

This attack is made against the next Lab Rat clockwise from the active Rat instead of the active Rat, wrapping around the table. Skip any Rat that has been knocked out.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Predatory Instinct
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

This attack is made against the Rat holding the greatest total Upgrade Value instead of the active Rat. If tied, the player chooses. If only one Rat remains, it is the target.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Spliced Reflexes
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

This attack deals +1 damage for each Splice the Tyrant still holds.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Terrifying Roar
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

The Tyrant deals no damage this attack. Instead, exhaust 1 die from the shared battle pool. The player chooses which die.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Crushing Blow
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

1 damage from this attack is dealt directly to the target Rat's Health and cannot be absorbed by Upgrades. Any remaining damage is absorbed normally.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Unstable Growth
TYRANT ATTACK

REVEAL AFTER RAT TURN

Resolve this attack. If the target was not knocked out, the Tyrant immediately attacks again, committing 2 dice. Do not reveal a Tyrant Attack card for the second attack.

Discard after resolving. Reshuffle the discard when the deck is empty.

Buff HP
TYRANT · REMOVE BEFORE HEALTH

Optional. Hold part of the Tyrant's Health here: put the die on that many and spend it before the dial.

15	14	13
12	11	10
9	8	7
6	5	4
3	2	1

Rummage
SCROUNGER - SIDE A

HP 1 | STR 2 | REC 2

CAREFUL BORROWER
When checking whether a die Rummage borrowed is banished, you may reroll the check once.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

Fidget
TINKERER - SIDE A

HP 1 | STR 2 | REC 2

JURY-RIG
Once per Experiment, after Fidget rolls, reroll one miss. This does not use a Strategy phase.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

BAT

TYRANT ATTACK

THE NOBULOUS SET

Fidget

TINKERER - SIDE B

HP 1 | STR 2 | REC 2

FINE TUNING

Once per Experiment, reroll one of Fidget's basic hits. If the reroll misses, retain the original basic hit.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

Rummage

SCROUNGER - SIDE B

HP 1 | STR 2 | REC 2

TOOL KEEPER

When another Rat borrows one of Rummage's dice and it is not banished, return it available instead of exhausted.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

BAT

BUFF HP

THE NOBULOUS SET

Whiz

PRODIGY - SIDE A

HP 2 | STR 2 | REC 1

SELF-SUFFICIENT

If Whiz commits no borrowed die and does not use the Red die this Experiment, reduce the Experiment's Target by 1.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

Mottle

MUTANT - SIDE A

HP 2 | STR 2 | REC 1

EXPERIMENTAL SUBJECT

If at least one Specimen is revealed, Mottle has +1 STR for that Experiment and recovers 1 additional die this turn.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

Mottle

MUTANT - SIDE B

HP 2 | STR 2 | REC 1

SPECIMEN ADAPTATION

After Mottle completes an Experiment, recover 1 additional die for each Specimen Mottle holds.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.

Whiz

PRODIGY - SIDE B

HP 2 | STR 2 | REC 1

PREPARED

If a different Rat was active on the previous turn, recover 1 of Whiz's exhausted dice after selecting Whiz and before committing dice.

Choose one side of each Lab Rat at setup.